

STORE SUBMISSION READINESS AUDIT

ASSIZE Mobile

Configuration, privacy, listing, and compliance findings for the App Store and Google Play, audited against official store specifications at repository HEAD 8c64fa6 — with the four P0 blockers standing between the build and review.

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Native 0.86.3

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Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary and Verdict	1
1.1 Readiness snapshot	1
2. Submission Blockers (P0)	2
2.1 Stub screens reachable from the hub (Apple 2.1 / Play Minimum Functionality)	2
2.2 No privacy policy URL (hard console requirement)	2
2.3 Release build defaults to http://localhost:3030 (src/game/net/client.ts)	3
2.4 No build and signing pipeline (no eas.json)	3
3. Store Listing and Asset Gaps	4
3.1 Apple App Store required fields	4
3.2 Google Play required fields	4
3.3 The five assets with baked-in Chinese text must be replaced before screenshots	5
4. Privacy, Compliance and Age Rating	6
5. Technical Configuration Findings	7
5.1 Expo configuration (app.json)	7
5.2 Native asset inventory	7
5.3 SDK levels and store floors	7
6. ASO Metadata Plan (Challenger Tier)	8
7. Prioritized Action Plan	9
8. Audit Limitations	10

1. Executive Summary and Verdict

This audit assesses the ASSIZE mobile build (Expo SDK 57 / React Native 0.86.3, repository HEAD **8c64fa6**) against the submission requirements of the Apple App Store and Google Play, using the official store specifications compiled in the ASO skill (v2.0.1, March 2026 data) as the benchmark. The application is a dark, gothic 1v1 sudoku duel set in the plague-walled city of Novem, with a campaign spine (Folios I-IX), an ending-choice system, daily and weekly repeatable modes, and a server-backed matchmaking design that is not yet implemented on mobile. The audit covers the Expo configuration, native asset inventory, privacy posture, network behaviour, and the store-listing surface that must exist in App Store Connect and Play Console before either store will accept the app.

NOT READY TO
SUBMIT

4 P0 blockers must be cleared first; most of the build is already
store-grade

The verdict is deliberately blunt but the underlying picture is positive. The technical foundation is unusually clean for an indie title: no permissions are requested, no analytics or tracking SDKs are present, export compliance is pre-answered in Info.plist, the 1024-px icon is alpha-free as Apple requires, and Expo SDK 57 targets Android API 36, comfortably above Google's current floor. The gaps that remain are concentrated in four places - unfinished hub screens that a reviewer will find in minutes, a missing privacy policy, an unconfigured release network endpoint, and the absence of any build/signing pipeline - plus the standard pile of listing assets (screenshots, feature graphic, metadata) that simply do not exist yet. Every one of these is closable with focused work, and none requires re-architecting the app.

1.1 Readiness snapshot

Area	Status	Detail
App configuration (app.json)	PASS	Bundle IDs consistent, icon/splash/adaptive icon present, dark UI, portrait, scheme set
Store SDK compliance	PASS	Expo SDK 57: Android targetSdk 36 (Play floor 35), iOS 18 SDK (Apple floor, Apr 2025)
Permissions and privacy surface	PASS	Zero dangerous permissions; no analytics, ads, or trackers; no secrets in source
Campaign content (Phase 3)	PASS	StoryCard, OrderSelect, FolioMap, FolioDetail, EndingChoice all ported and gated
Hub completeness	FAIL	14 screens are 22-line stubs reachable from the hub, including the hero CTA

Area	Status	Detail
Privacy policy	FAIL	No hosted policy URL anywhere in the repo; required by both consoles
Release network config	FAIL	Net client defaults to http://localhost:3030 in the absence of a build-time env var
Build and signing pipeline	FAIL	No eas.json; no reproducible production AAB/IPA path
Store listing assets	FAIL	No screenshots, feature graphic, or listing metadata prepared for either console

Table 1: Submission readiness by area at HEAD 8c64fa6.

2. Submission Blockers (P0)

These four findings are hard blockers: each one either gives an app reviewer a legitimate rejection ground, breaks a console requirement at upload time, or ships a visibly broken experience to the first real user. They are ordered by review-severity, not by fix effort. Each blocker cites the evidence found in the repository so the fix can be verified against the same source.

2.1 Stub screens reachable from the hub (Apple 2.1 / Play Minimum Functionality)

Fourteen screens under `mobile/src/ui/screens/` are 22-line placeholder files: Cabinet, Daily, Echoes, Endless, Friend, LedgerProfile, Matchmaking, Offline, Purse, Reliquary, SeasonLedger, Settings, Versus, and Weekly. The Antechamber hub routes to them unconditionally: the primary hero card (Antechamber.tsx line 139) calls `tap('matchmaking')`, and the gear button in the header routes to `tap('settings')`. Apple's guideline 2.1 (App Completeness) rejects apps whose core navigation leads to non-functional placeholders, and Google Play's Minimum Functionality policy treats the same condition as grounds for rejection or takedown. A reviewer who taps the biggest card on the hub and lands on a dead screen will stop reviewing right there.

There are two viable paths. The intended one is to port Phase 4 of the 17-screen map (4.1 Daily, 4.2 Weekly, 4.3 Endless, and the hidden blocker 4.4 serverDuel) so the hub entries become real. The pragmatic one, if a 2026 launch target matters more than feature parity, is to gate the stub entries out of the hub for v1.0 exactly the way the campaign hub already flips its Folios card on `foliosSettled` - ship campaign + duel + result only, and widen the hub when the repeatable modes land. Shipping a hub whose hero card dead-ends is not one of the options.

2.2 No privacy policy URL (hard console requirement)

Both consoles require a reachable privacy policy URL before an app can be submitted: Play Console refuses store-listing publication without it, and App Store Connect requires it for the App Privacy section. The repository contains none - there is no privacy file anywhere in the tree. The app does have excellent in-app copy already written in `src/i18n/en.json`: 'No email. No trackers. A guest number lives on your device. The court keeps your Standing, your daily times, and nothing that names you.' That statement is an accurate

description of the app's local-only data posture, but a paragraph inside the app is not a policy page.

The fix is small and worth doing precisely: host a short policy document (GitHub Pages or any static host) that states what the in-app copy states - local storage via MMKV/SQLite/SecureStore, no accounts, no analytics, no third-party trackers - plus a contact address, then register that URL in both consoles and link it from the Settings screen when that screen becomes real. If multiplayer ships in the same release, the policy must also disclose that gameplay data and a guest identifier reach the duel server, matching the Data Safety and App Privacy declarations described in section 4.

2.3 Release build defaults to `http://localhost:3030` (`src/game/net/client.ts`)

`serverOrigin()` resolves in order: the `EXPO_PUBLIC_ASSIZE_SERVER` build-time env var, then the hardcoded `DEFAULT_SERVER` `'http://localhost:3030'`. A production build produced without the env var therefore ships pointing at the user's own phone - matchmaking cannot work - and even with a server configured over plain http, the connection would be blocked at the OS layer: iOS App Transport Security refuses cleartext HTTP by default and Android 9+ blocks cleartext unless `usesCleartextTraffic` is explicitly enabled. The code comment shows the mechanism is deliberate (configure once at build time), but nothing enforces it, so the failure mode is silent.

The fix is to make production fail closed: throw or disable the Versus flow when `EXPO_PUBLIC_ASSIZE_SERVER` is absent at build time, require the https scheme for any configured origin, and inject the real value from `eas.json` (or the chosen build pipeline) rather than relying on shell state. This blocker composes with 2.1: if the Versus entry is gated out for v1.0, the localhost default becomes unreachable dead code, but the fail-closed guard should land either way so the first production build with the server enabled cannot regress to localhost by accident.

2.4 No build and signing pipeline (no `eas.json`)

Neither the repository nor the mobile workspace contains an `eas.json`, and there is no documented manual prebuild-plus-Xcode/Android-Studio signing flow either. Without it there is no reproducible path to the two artifacts the consoles accept - an .ipa built with a distribution certificate and provisioning profile, and a release .aab signed with an upload key - and no place to inject build-time environment such as `EXPO_PUBLIC_ASSIZE_SERVER`. Store metadata that must be set at build time (`versionCode` on Android, `buildNumber` on iOS) currently relies on Expo defaults of 1, which is fine for the first submission but will not survive the second one without explicit management.

The fix is a small configuration file, not a project: an `eas.json` with a production profile that sets auto-increment for `versionCode` and `buildNumber`, references the correct credentials (or defers to EAS-managed credentials), and carries the env block for the server origin. If EAS Build is not the chosen path, the equivalent is a documented prebuild + Fastlane (or manual Xcode / Gradle) procedure checked into the repository - the audit's requirement is only that the process exists, is reproducible, and injects the server origin explicitly.

3. Store Listing and Asset Gaps

Neither console has a store listing prepared: there is no metadata file, no fastlane/deliver structure, and no capture pipeline for screenshots anywhere in the repository. The tables below list the required fields per console with their official limits, from the ASO skill's compiled specs. Everything in these tables must exist before the consoles will accept a release; the character limits are hard-enforced at entry time.

3.1 Apple App Store required fields

Field	Limit	Required?	Status / note
App name	30 chars	Yes	Planned copy in section 6
Subtitle	30 chars	Yes	Indexed for search; planned in section 6
Keywords field	100 bytes	Yes	Hidden; commas, no spaces; byte math for CJK
Description	4,000 chars	Yes	Not indexed; conversion copy only
Promotional text	170 chars	Optional	Updatable without a release; recommend using it
6.9-inch iPhone screenshots	1260 x 2736	Yes (1-10)	First 3 carry ~90% of conversion
13-inch iPad screenshots	2064 x 2752	Yes (1-10)	Required because supportsTablet is true
App preview video	15-30 s, up to 3	Optional	+20-40% CVR lift on iOS; decide later
Privacy policy URL	-	Yes	Blocker 2.2
App Privacy answers	-	Yes	See section 4

Table 2: App Store Connect submission fields (apple-specs.md, March 2026).

The iPad row deserves emphasis. The configuration sets `ios.supportsTablet` to true, so the app will be distributed to iPads and Apple will require the 13-inch screenshot set; the portrait-only, `requireFullScreen` configuration is acceptable, but the screenshots must show the app running on iPad dimensions, not stretched phone frames. If iPad distribution is not wanted for v1.0, the alternative is to set `supportsTablet` to false and target iPhone only, which removes that entire screenshot track - a legitimate scope decision that should be made consciously rather than by default.

3.2 Google Play required fields

Field	Limit	Required?	Status / note
App title	30 chars	Yes	No emoji, ALL-CAPS, or 'best/free' claims (2021 policy)
Short description	80 chars	Yes	Indexed; visible without expanding
Full description	4,000 chars	Yes	Indexed heavily; target 2-3% natural keyword density

Field	Limit	Required?	Status / note
Phone screenshots	2-8, 1080x1920 rec.	Yes (min 2)	Max 8, not Apple's 10
7-inch + 10-inch tablet screenshots	min 4 each	Yes if tablet-optimized	Same track decision as iOS supportsTablet
Feature graphic	1024 x 500 exact	Yes	Required for any featuring; missing today
App icon (listing)	512 x 512, 32-bit PNG	Yes	Can be derived from existing 1024 icon
Data safety form	-	Yes	See section 4
Content rating (IARC)	-	Yes	Questionnaire; see section 4
Privacy policy URL	-	Yes	Blocker 2.2

Table 3: Play Console submission fields (google-play-specs.md, March 2026).

3.3 The five assets with baked-in Chinese text must be replaced before screenshots

The earlier asset audit (Task 8) identified exactly five images with Chinese text baked into the art - AI-generation artifacts that ship identically in the web build's public/ directory. The Order portraits and the Ilse portrait appear on hub-adjacent screens that will be in the first screenshot wave, and a store listing whose artwork carries a language the listing does not support reads as a localization defect to reviewers and users alike (Apple guideline 2.3.8 expects metadata and visuals appropriate for the declared audience). These five files are the highest-leverage art fix available and should be regenerated at source before any screenshot is captured, since they are visible on the OrderSelect screen and in story cards.

Asset	Text baked in	Meaning	Appears on
order-scholar.webp	笔之秩序	Order of the Quill	OrderSelect portrait
order-executioner.webp	斧头教团	Order of the Axe	OrderSelect portrait
order-warden.webp	提灯教团	Order of the Lantern	OrderSelect portrait
shade-orsolo.webp	暗影	Shadow	Story / reveal card
mag-ilse.webp	打钟人伊尔泽	Bellringer Ilse	Folio detail portrait

Table 4: Source-art assets carrying Chinese glyphs (identified in Task 8).

4. Privacy, Compliance and Age Rating

The privacy surface of this app is the simplest a store reviewer can encounter, and that is a competitive advantage worth protecting. A full scan of package.json and src/ found no analytics, no advertising, no crash-reporting, and no social SDKs; persistence is entirely on-device through MMKV, expo-sqlite, and expo-secure-store; and the only network surface is the socket.io duel client, which is currently unreachable in production (blocker 2.3). No dangerous Android permission and no iOS purpose string is required by any installed plugin: expo-audio is used for playback only with no recording API call anywhere in src/, expo-sharing and the RN Share sheet operate on locally produced content, and expo-haptics, expo-clipboard, expo-crypto, and expo-file-system are permissionless on current OS versions. The result is that neither OS will show a single permission dialog on first launch.

Declaration	Correct answer today	If multiplayer ships in the same release
Play Data Safety - data collected	None (local-only saves, no accounts)	Declare user/gameplay identifiers transmitted to the duel server; state retention honestly
Apple App Privacy - data collected	Data Not Collected	Declare Identifiers and Gameplay data; link the same privacy policy
Privacy policy URL	Required (blocker 2.2)	Same URL, expanded with the server disclosure
IARC content rating	Answer the questionnaire honestly; gothic themes without gore or gambling typically land 4+/Everyone or 9+/Everyone 10+	Same questionnaire; no change expected
Apple age rating	Answer violence/fear questions honestly; abstract puzzle with dark framing, no realistic violence	Same
Account deletion (Apple 5.1.1(v))	Not applicable - the app creates no accounts	Still not applicable if accounts remain guest-only and server-side state is erasable on request
Export compliance	Already answered: ITSAAppUsesNonExemptEncryption = false	Unchanged (HTTPS-only traffic is exempt)
In-app purchases	None - no IAP SDK present	Unchanged unless monetization ships

Table 5: Console privacy and compliance declarations and how the multiplayer decision changes them.

The single decision that moves every row of this table is the multiplayer ship decision from section 2.1. The matchmaking protocol sends a guest name, order choice, and standing to the duel server (QueueJoined.foe in src/game/net/client.ts), so the moment that flow becomes reachable in production, 'no data collected' stops being an honest answer on both consoles. The recommended sequencing is to ship v1.0 with the Versus entry gated and the local-only declarations, then file the disclosure updates in the same release that enables matchmaking - declarations must always match what the shipping binary can actually do, and consoles treat mismatches as policy violations rather than paperwork errors.

5. Technical Configuration Findings

5.1 Expo configuration (app.json)

Setting	Value	Assessment
Bundle identifier / package	com.assize.game / com.assize.game	Consistent across platforms; verify availability at registration time
Version / versionCode / buildNumber	1.0.0 / default 1 / default 1	Fine for first submission; manage explicitly from the second build (blocker 2.4)
Orientation / UI style	portrait / dark	Matches the game's design; dark <code>userInterfaceStyle</code> declared
ios.supportsTablet	true	Triggers the 13-inch iPad screenshot track (section 3.1); confirm intent
ios.requireFullScreen	true	No Split View/Slide Over; acceptable for a game
Export compliance	ITSAAppUsesNonExemptEncryption = false	Answers Apple's encryption question before it is asked
Adaptive icon layers	foreground, background, monochrome	Complete set including Android 13+ themed icons
Splash	expo-splash-screen plugin, contain, #0e0e0f	Configured via plugin; colors come from theme constants
assetBundlePatterns	"**/*"	Legacy OTA pattern bundling everything; remove for a leaner bundle (P2)

Table 6: app.json audit at HEAD 8c64fa6.

5.2 Native asset inventory

File	Dimensions / mode	Assessment
icon.png	1024 x 1024, RGB	PASS - Apple store icon must be alpha-free; this one already is
android-icon-foreground.png	512 x 512, RGBA	Works; regenerate at 1024 for crisper scaling (P2)
android-icon-background.png	512 x 512, RGBA	PASS
android-icon-monochrome.png	432 x 432, RGBA	Low-resolution for a 108-px layer; regenerate at 1024 (P2)
splash-icon.png	1024 x 1024, palette PNG	PASS for splash rendering
favicon.png	48 x 48, RGBA	Web-only; irrelevant to stores

Table 7: mobile/assets inventory measured directly from the files.

5.3 SDK levels and store floors

Expo SDK 57 with React Native 0.86.3 sits comfortably past both stores' current floors. Google Play requires new apps and updates to target API 35 (Android 15) or higher; the SDK 57 toolchain targets API 36 with compileSdk 36. Apple's requirement, in force since April 2025, is that apps be built with Xcode 16 and the iOS 18 SDK, which the SDK 57 build pipeline satisfies. Both verifications should be re-confirmed on the first generated native project - one glance at targetSdkVersion in the generated android/build.gradle and the Xcode version in CI - because the consoles read the binary, not the JavaScript configuration. No action is needed today beyond that confirmation at build time, and none is expected.

6. ASO Metadata Plan (Challenger Tier)

A pre-launch title with zero ratings and no install base is a textbook Challenger under the ASO skill's brand-maturity tiers: every indexed character must work for discovery, and deviations from textbook practice are mistakes rather than data-informed choices. The current Expo name 'ASSIZE' uses 6 of 30 characters and carries no keyword, which scores 3/10 under the Challenger rubric - the brand is the only signal, and nobody is searching for a brand they have never heard of. The web build's existing metadata provides strong seed copy: 'a sudoku duel in the plague-walled city of Novem' and the open-graph line 'A 1v1 sudoku duel. The Tablet does not forgive.'

The proposed set below keeps the brand first (recognition, wordmark consistency) and spends the remaining characters on the two terms that describe the product to a stranger: sudoku and duel. On Google Play the title avoids ALL CAPS because Play's 2021 metadata policy prohibits all-caps titles for anything short of a registered brand; on Apple the caps are harmless and the wordmark stays. Every count below is computed, not estimated, and the keyword field deliberately avoids repeating any word already indexed in the title or subtitle, because Apple indexes each word once.

Field (console)	Proposed copy	Count
App name (Apple, 30)	ASSIZE: Gothic Sudoku Duel	26/30
App title (Play, 30)	Assize: Gothic Sudoku Duel	26/30 (title-case for Play policy)
Subtitle (Apple, 30)	1v1 puzzle duels, plague city	29/30
Short description (Play, 80)	A 1v1 sudoku duel. The Tablet does not forgive.	47/80
Keywords (Apple, 100 bytes)	ink,court,magistrate,law,solve,logic,daily,endless,pvp,board	60/100 bytes, no overlap with title/subtitle

Table 8: proposed listing copy with verified character budgets.

For the Play full description (4,000 characters, fully indexed), open with the value proposition in the first three sentences - the plague city, the sealed Tablet, the Shade opponent - because Google NLP weighs the opening and users see only the first lines before expanding. Structure the body into short labelled sections (campaign, daily and weekly rites, the ranked duel), reuse the category keywords naturally at roughly two to three percent density, and close with a call to action, which is permitted in the description on both stores. Apple's description is conversion-only since it is not indexed: the same structure works, but keyword density is irrelevant there and

the promotional text field (170 characters) should carry the rotating hook instead. Without paid ASO tooling the keyword volumes above are estimates; validate them in AppTweak, Sensor Tower, or MobileAction before locking the keyword field.

7. Prioritized Action Plan

The plan below is ordered by review impact, then effort. P0 items are the four blockers from section 2 and gate any submission attempt; P1 items are the listing and art work that gates console completeness; P2 items are polish that improves quality without blocking anything. Effort labels assume one engineer familiar with the codebase: S is under half a day, M is one to two days, L is a multi-day port.

Pri	Action	Effort	Impact
P0	Clear blocker 2.1: port Phase 4 screens or gate stub entries out of the hub for v1.0	L or M	Removes the Apple 2.1 / Play minimum-functionality rejection
P0	Clear blocker 2.2: host privacy policy, register URL in both consoles	S	Console hard requirement
P0	Clear blocker 2.3: fail-closed server origin, https enforced, injected at build time	S	Prevents silent dead multiplayer in production
P0	Clear blocker 2.4: add eas.json (or documented signing flow) with auto-increment versions	S-M	Reproducible store artifacts
P1	Regenerate the five Chinese-text source assets (table 4) at web + mobile source	M	Screenshots and review optics; single source of truth for both builds
P1	Capture screenshots: 6.9-inch + 13-inch iPad (Apple), 8 phone shots + feature graphic 1024x500 (Play)	M	Console completeness; first-3 screenshots drive conversion
P1	Enter listing copy from section 6; complete Data Safety, App Privacy, and IARC forms	S	Console completeness
P2	Regenerate adaptive icon layers at 1024; remove assetBundlePatterns; explicit versionCode/buildNumber	S	Polish, bundle size, release hygiene

Table 9: submission work plan ordered by priority.

The recommended order of operations within P1 matters: regenerate the five assets before capturing any screenshot, capture screenshots before writing final copy (the copy should reference what the screens actually show), and fill the console forms last, once the multiplayer ship decision is final, so the privacy declarations are answered exactly once. If the Phase 4 port is chosen for P0, the same release can carry the hub widening and the Versus enablement together, and the section 4 table's right-hand column becomes the operative answer for the first submission rather than a future patch.

8. Audit Limitations

This is a pre-submission audit of code and configuration, not of a live listing, so several ASO dimensions are structurally out of scope. Ratings and reviews, download ranges, and conversion signals cannot be scored before launch; the ASO skill's six-dimension scorecard was therefore used as a requirements framework rather than a scored audit, and only the metadata dimensions received explicit recommendations. Keyword volumes and difficulty scores require paid tooling (AppTweak, Sensor Tower, or MobileAction at roughly 69 USD per month each) and are estimates here; the keyword set in section 6 should be validated against real search-volume data before it is locked into App Store Connect.

Three findings are verified against SDK defaults rather than a generated native project, because running expo prebuild mutates the working tree and was out of scope for an audit pass: the Android targetSdk level, the exact permission set in the merged manifest, and the iOS Info.plist contents should each be confirmed once on the first clean production build and are expected to confirm cleanly given the plugin set. Finally, the console forms themselves - Data Safety, App Privacy, IARC - depend on the multiplayer ship decision documented in section 4, and any reviewer at Apple or Google exercises individual judgment; none of the recommendations here can guarantee an approval outcome, only remove the known, objective grounds for rejection.